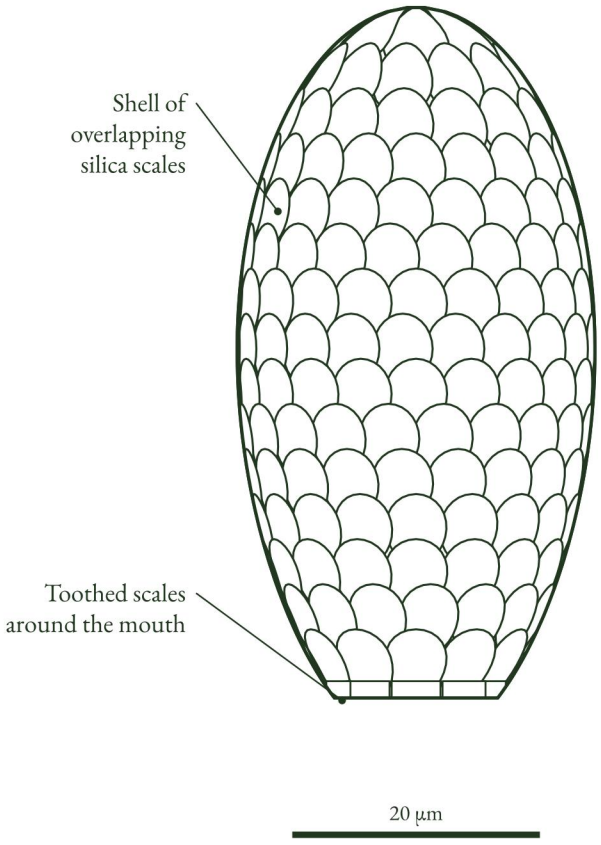
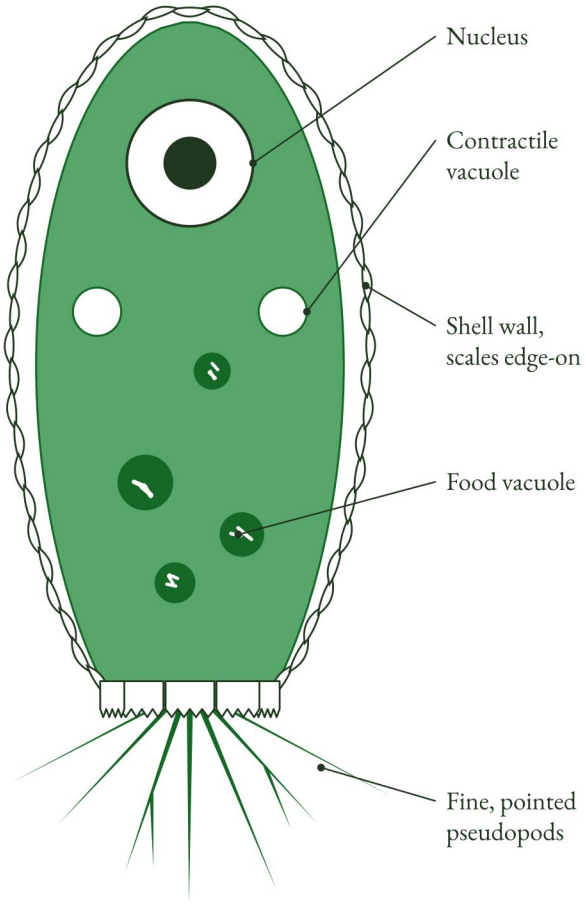
Euglypha

A shelled amoeba that builds its house from glass

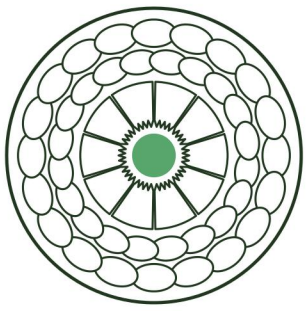
Testate amoeba · Rhizaria · Cercozoa · Euglyphida



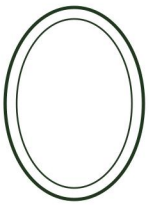
A Shell surface



B Living cell, mid focus



C The mouth, end-on



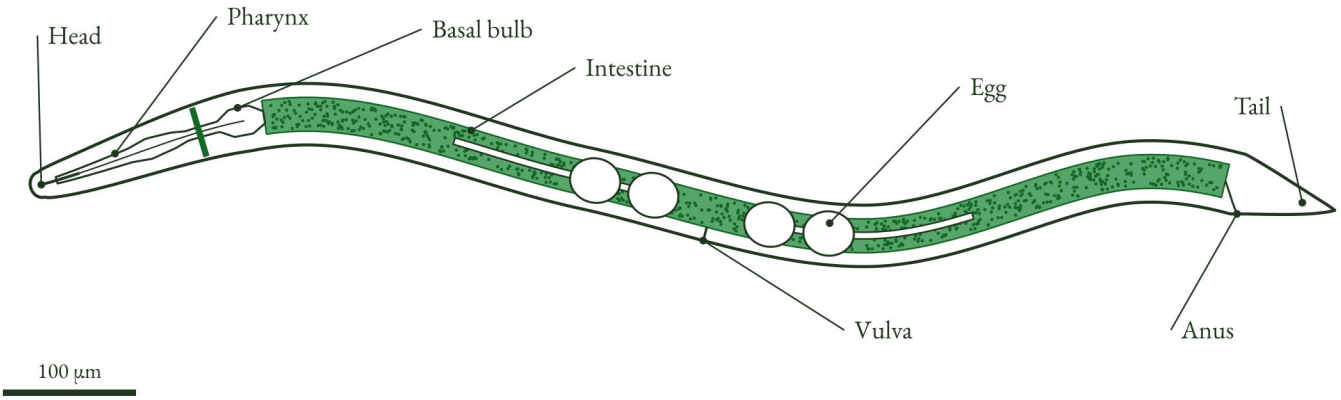
D One scale

Size	Shell about 30 to 100 µm long, depending on the species.
Where	Moist soil, leaf litter and moss.
Eats	Bacteria, fungi and small algae, caught with fine pointed pseudopods.
Shell	Silica scales the cell makes itself. It stores a full new set before it divides.
At 400x	A clear, glassy shell. Focus on the surface for the scale pattern, then on the middle for the cell. Look for the toothed mouth.

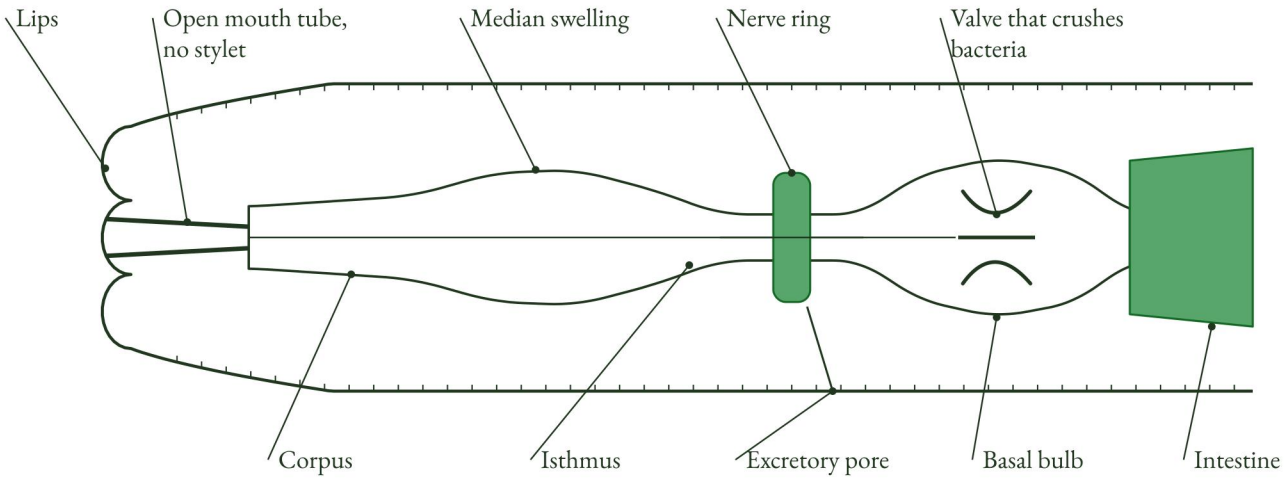
Bacterial-feeding nematode

A roundworm that grazes on bacteria and releases nitrogen for plants

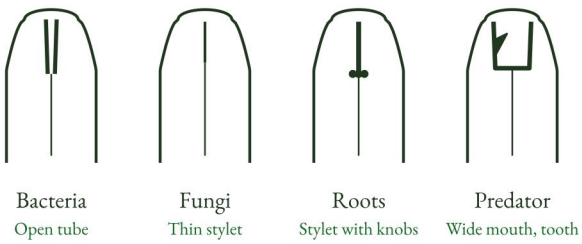
Nematoda · Rhabditida · for example Rhabditis, Cephalobus, Acrobeles



A Whole worm, female, about 1 mm



B Head and pharynx, where you identify it



C What each group eats, read from the head

Size	Most are 0.3 to 2 mm long.
Where	Water films around soil particles, around roots and in compost.
Eats	Bacteria, sucked in through the open mouth and crushed in the basal bulb.
Role	It eats more nitrogen than it needs and releases the rest as ammonium, a form plant roots can take up.
At 400x	Look at the head: an open tube, no stylet, and a round bulb that pumps as it feeds.